

run the code below for you to get a simple Web server serving the page from the specified directory.

```
var express = require('express');
var stPages = require('serve-static');

var port = 3000;
var dir = '/public';

var app = express();
app.use(stPages(__dirname + dir));
app.listen(port);
```

The Express response object and its methods

The Express response object is derived from the standard Node.js server response object. It has some utility functions too. Some frequently used functions are listed below:

1. `append()`
2. `cookie()`
3. `clearCookie()`
4. `end()`
5. `get()`
6. `json()`
7. `redirect()`
8. `render()`
9. `set()`
10. `status()`

The Express request object and its methods

This object is a wrapper for Node.js' `http.request` object. The code, `req.get('Content-Type')`; returns the HTTP request header. The code, `req.is('text/html')`; returns 'true' if the MIME type is text/HTML.

Some frequently used functions are listed below:

1. `accepts()`
2. `acceptsCharsets()`
3. `acceptsEncodings()`
4. `acceptsLanguages()`
5. `param()`

Express routes

Express provides good URL based routing. The Express route object has the `get`, `post`, `put` and `delete` functions. Routing defines how to respond to a client request for a particular path (URI). We can have multiple handler functions for routes and they will be executed if the route is matched.

```
var express = require('express');
var port = 3000;
var app = express();

app.get('/', function (req, res) {
```

```
    res.send('Hello World!');
});

app.get('/user', function (req, res) {
    res.send('Requesting /user');
});

app.get('/user/task', function (req, res) {
    res.send('Requesting /user/task');
});

var server = app.listen(port, function () {
    var host = server.address().hostname;
    var port = server.address().port;
    console.log('Open web browser and type http://localhost:%s in address bar!', port);
});
```

Router

A Router object is an instance of routes. It can be created easily, as shown below, and we can also add the methods `get`, `post`, `put` and `delete`, just like we add them in applications.

```
var router = express.Router([options]);
```

Methods available in Router are:

1. `all()`
2. `get()`
3. `post()`
4. `put()`
5. `delete()`
6. `param()`
7. `route()`
8. `use()`

Some code snippets using Router are given here:

```
router.use(express.static(__dirname + '/public'));

router.use(function(req, res){
    res.send('Hello World!');
});
```

Readers are advised to further explore the examples provided at <http://expressjs.com/en/> . 

References

- [1] <http://expressjs.com>
- [2] <https://nodejs.org>

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